

Tech that didn't get the memo

Typewriter

The word "Typewriter" doesn't elicit the same response as it used to before the digital age of computers took off. Despite being the butt of jokes – the longest English word typed off a single row of the keyboard is? – the venerable typewriter refuses to die down. Sure, there's no on-the-fly word editing and every mistake costs a fresh copy of paper, there are still quite a few ben-



Look at the smile on this typist's face. (Wo) man and machine, in perfect harmony.

efits of using the good old typewriter. Nostalgia is one of them – for people who've only ever typed on a typewriter, nothing else will cut it. Compare it to the possessiveness TVS' mechanical keyboard owners have towards their input device, and you will only come close to what ardent typewriter aficionados have always felt for their beloved typewriters. With such strong sentiments at stake, how can anyone even think of sweeping these tried and tested machines under the carpet? We can only hope that with the dawn of the digital age, and companies kicking into their eco drive, the humble typewriter (which doesn't run on electricity) may still have quite a few takers than you'd care to imagine.

Optical Drive

Apple has a long history of starting a trend and then unceremoniously dumping it by the roadside. While we don't exactly remember which company's credited with inducting the optical drive into our PC cabinets (if you know the answer, please let us know), we know that Apple caused a big hue and cry last year when it decided to pull the slot-loading optical drive off its iMac desktop computer -- the Cupertino giant had already pulled the drive off its Mac mini offerings since 2011. But whatever Apple does, the computer industry follows suit -- that has been the general trend over the past decade. However, the optical drive remains an exception. While it's seeing a decline among computers, Blu-ray discs are pretty much the name of the game in entertainment. And despite the advent of internet and online entertainment, the good old optical media will still go strong for a few more years.

Fax

You might think of them to be relics of the past, only good for the dustbins but you will have a hard time selling that idea to the Japanese. Last year Japanese households – yes, households not companies, bought roughly 1.7 million fax machines. They use it for everything ranging from ordering food, conducting business to having a conversation with friends or sending quick notes to acquaintances. Even the Yakuza uses it to send instructions to it's members. Though not as extensively as Japan, fax machines are still in use in most parts of the world.

Short for facsimile, a fax machine transfers a scanned document through the telephone line to a telephone number connected to another such device. They're still extensively used to transfer sensitive



Time for some serious work

documents which when transferred over the Internet unencrypted may be intercepted by a third-party, but it's impossible to intercept faxes without tapping the telephone line, and that can only happen if the law enforcement agencies have started taking interested in you. Faxes also come in handy when exchanging legal papers or signing contracts, some countries do not accept electronic signatures on such documents which leaves the humble Fax as the only option.

Landlines

Even in these interesting times when you see most of the people furiously swiping and tapping away on their smartphones and wearable communication systems just exploding into the scene – the original telephones are still going strong. Apart from according the users the satisfaction of having talked (or a shouting match depending on which part of the world you're talking from and to) with someone situated on the other side of the line, they offer the obvious benefits of better call fidelity and cheaper calls.

The most important benefit of owning a landline is the it's immunity to the bane of mobile phones – bad coverage and battery life. You can

